

Rhine Valley Chemicals GmbH — On-Site Audit Report

Facility:	Ludwigshafen production site, Germany
Audit type:	ISO 14001 environmental + REACH chemical compliance audit
Audit dates:	2026-01-20 to 2026-01-21 (2 days)
Auditor:	Meridian Assurance Partners (third-party)
Overall rating:	Conditional — Medium-High Risk

Executive Summary

This audit of Rhine Valley Chemicals' Ludwigshafen site found the facility's core environmental management system to be well established, but identified chemical labeling, engineering, and PPE-compliance gaps that require corrective action before the next audit cycle.

Chemical Handling & Labeling

Of 40 sampled chemical storage containers, 3 were found with safety data sheet labels that did not match the current REACH registration for the substance inside (two due to an unrecorded supplier reformulation, one due to a transcription error during relabeling). No exposure incidents were linked to the mislabeling, but the facility's relabeling verification step failed to catch the discrepancy.

Environmental

Facility self-reporting logs show one wastewater pH excursion event in the preceding 6 months (2025-10-03, pH 5.4 against a permit floor of 6.0), attributed to a neutralization dosing pump fault. The facility reported the excursion to the regulator within the required window and replaced the pump the same day; no repeat excursions have occurred since.

Health & Safety

Respiratory protective equipment fit-testing was found overdue for 12% of workers classified as at-risk for airborne exposure, against the facility's own policy of annual fit-testing for this group. Spill containment berms around Tank Farm B were measured and found undersized for the worst-case single-tank failure volume specified in the facility's own risk assessment — an engineering non-conformance rather than an operational one.

Corrective Action Log

Finding	Severity	Due Date	Status
Mislabeled chemical storage containers (3 of 40 sampled)	Major	30 days	Open
Respiratory PPE fit-testing overdue (12% of at-risk workers)	Major	45 days	Open
Tank Farm B containment berms undersized for worst case	Major	90 days	Open
Wastewater pH excursion, 2025-10-03	Minor	Closed	Closed — pump replaced

Conclusion

Recommendation: conditional pass. Follow-up audit scheduled for 2026-04-20 (90 days), aligned to the longest-lead-time item (containment berm engineering work). Certification will be downgraded if the labeling and PPE findings are not closed within their stated deadlines.